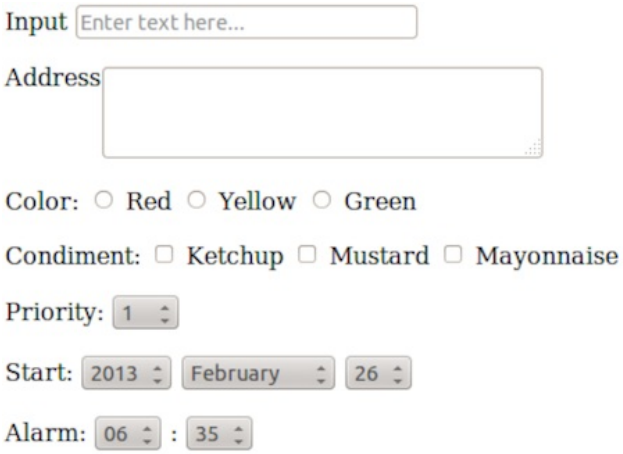
Generating Forms

HTML provides a number of elements, attributes, and attribute values that control how input is gathered. You certainly could hand-code your form directly into the template, but there's no need to.

In this section, we'll cover a number of *helpers* that Rails provides that assist with this process. In *Using Helpers*, we'll show you how you can create your own helpers.

HTML provides a number of ways to collect data in forms. A few of the more common means are shown in the following screenshot. Note that the form itself isn't representative of any sort of typical use; in general, you'll use only a subset of these methods to collect data.



Let's look at the template that was used to produce that form:

rails7/views/app/views/form/input.html.erb

```
1:  <%= form_for(:model) do |form| %>
 -  <p>
 -    <%= form.label :input %>
 -    <%= form.text_field :input, :placeholder => 'Enter text here...' %>
5:  </p>
 -
 -  <p>
 -    <%= form.label :address, :style => 'float: left' %>
 -    <%= form.text_area :address, :rows => 3, :cols => 40 %>
```